INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TAB, INDEX, PRESSURE SENSITIVE, TRANSPARENT

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers transparent pressure sensitive index tab sets for identifying segregation in file and directory reference material, alphabetical or otherwise.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. The tabs shall be furnished in the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2). Tabs having no legends, or different dimensions, legends, color or number of tabs per set may be ordered under this specification provided they conform to all other requirements of this specification (see 6.2 and 6.3).

Type I - Individual printed tab sets.
  Class 1 - Angle Projection.
  Class 2 - Round Projection.
Type II - Transparent insertable 6 inch tab strips.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-121 - Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks, and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification :

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods:

T 402 os - 49 - Conditioning paper and paperboard for testing.
T 410 os - 61 - Basis weight of paper and paperboard.
T 411 os - 44 - Thickness and density of paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10017.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, D. C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies shall be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 202, Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material shall be as specified herein. Where material is not definitely defined, it shall be of the quality, composition, and thickness best suited for the intended purpose.

3.1.1 Plastic. The transparent plastic film shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table I. The plastic shall be nonflammable or shall have a burning rate not exceeding five inches per minute, when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.3.

TABLE I. Tensile strength and elongation

Tensile strength, pound per square inch, minimum	5300
Elongation at rupture, percent, minimum	25

3.1.1.1 Transparency of tab skirt. The tab skirts shall be sufficiently transparent to allow easy reading of 10 point (1/8 inch) type, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.1.2 Adhesive. The adhesive shall be a pressure sensitive, transparent, water insoluble homogeneous material capable of withstanding changes in temperature and humidity experienced in normal atmospheric conditions. It shall have satisfactory adhesive quality to comply with the test specified in 4.4.2.1. The adhesive shall require no moisture, heat, or other special preparation prior to applying tab to paper.

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3.1.3 Release liner or backing. The paper of the release liner or backing shall be treated with an appropriate release liner treatment material that allows pressure sensitive tabs to be released from the release liner or backing without tearing or causing separation of the adhesive from the tab.

3.1.4 Insert labels, blank and alphabetical (type II). The paper stock shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table II. The paper shall have a smooth surface receptive to writing or typing with ink without feathering or spreading, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.3.

TABLE II. Physical properties

Basis weight (25-1/2 x 30-1/2 inch - 500) pounds	65 (minimum)
Thickness, inch	0.0055 (minimum)

3.2 Type I, classes 1 and 2.

3.2.1 Design and construction. The tabs shall be manufactured of material as specified in 3.1. The tabs shall be pre-cut individually, and shall be of the dimensions specified in table III. The tabs shall be made of such material and designed and constructed so that the projection will stand erect. Forty percent or more of the lower portion of the skirt shall be evenly coated with an adhesive conforming to 3.1.2. The adhesive shall be protected by release liner or backing conforming to 3.1.3.

3.2.1.1 Tab dimensions and legends. The tab dimensions and legends shall be as specified in table III. The legend shall be permanently and legibly printed on the plastic projection or on appropriate white paper securely attached to the inside of the tab protection, at the option of the manufacturer. The letters U and V and X, Y, and Z may be combined on one tab each. The name of the months and states may be abbreviated. The tab sets with the names of states shall at least contain all 50 states plus the District of Columbia.

TABLE III. Type I, classes 1 and 2

Legend of tab	Number of tabs per set, minimum.	Tab projection width, tolerance ± 1/32 inch. **	Tab projection length, minimum. *	Skirt width, minimum. **	Height of legend, minimum.
Alphabet (a) + (b)	23	1/4, 3/8, or 1/2 inch	1/2 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch
Numbers 1 to 31 (a) + (b)	31	1/4, 3/8, or 1/2 inch	1/2 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch
Month (a) + (b)	12	1/4, 3/8, or 1/2 inch	1/2 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch
States (a) + (b)	51	1/4, 3/8, or 1/2 inch	1/2 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch

NOTES: (a) Side attachment, vertical reading.
(b) Top attachment, horizontal reading.
* Length is the dimension parallel with the edge of item to which attached.
** Width is the measurement taken at right angle to which attached.

3.2.2 Type II.

3.2.2.1 Design and construction. The tabs shall be manufactured of material as specified in 3.1. The dimensions shall be as specified in table IV. The tab shall be one continuous 6 inch strip that may be cut to the desired length. The tab shall be made of such material and designed and constructed so that the projection will stand erect with or without the insert. The projection shall have a double beaded edge, and the projection and skirt shall be physically divided by a divider (saddle). The divider shall serve to hold paper insert label in place, and serve as a stop when attaching tab to paper. Forty percent or more of the lower portion of the skirt shall be evenly coated with an adhesive conforming to 3.1.2. The adhesive shall be protected by release liner conforming to 3.1.3.

3.2.2.2 Tab dimensions, legend of tabs, and height of legend. The dimensions, and legend of tabs, and height of legend shall be as specified in table IV (see 3.2.2.3 and 3.2.2.4):

TABLE IV. Type II tabs

Legend of tabs	Tab length, tolerances ± 1/8 inch. *	Tab projection width, tolerance ± 1/32 inch. **	Skirt width minimum. **	Height of legend, minimum.
Alphabet	6 inches	1/3 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch
Alphabet	6 inches	1/2 inch	5/16 inch	1/8 inch

* Length is the dimension parallel with edge of paper to which attached.
** Width is the dimension taken at right angle to the length of tab.

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3.2.2.3 Sets. Each set shall contain the following: two strips of six inch insertable tabs; two strips of insert labels, each consisting of not less than twelve inches of blank insert labels, and insert labels with not less than two complete alphabets, or one complete alphabet and two series of letters A thru H. The letters U and V, and X, Y, and Z may be combined on one tab each.

3.2.2.4 Insert labels. The insert labels shall be made of material as specified in 3.1.4. The labels shall be connected in one continuous strip to facilitate feeding into typewriter. The strip shall be perforated for ease in tearing apart, and shall be scored or perforated along the longitudinal center line to permit and facilitate folding of label. When inserted, the folded label shall cover the entire inside of the projection. When printed insert labels are folded, the same letter shall appear on both sides of the insert label. To enable each tab to be used for vertical and horizontal indexing, one letter shall be printed parallel to the longitudinal center line of the label and the other at right angle to the center.

3.2.2.5 Color. Unless otherwise specified in the procurement document, the six inch insertable tab strip shall be clear, colorless, and transparent plastic, and the insert labels shall be white paper (see 3.1.4). When colored tabs are specified, the six inch insertable tab projection, or the projection and skirt shall be made of transparent colored plastic, or the insert labels shall be of the color specified, or one side of the label shall be of the color specified and the reverse side shall be white. When colored insert labels (other than white) are supplied, the letters shall be printed on the colored side. On white insert labels the letters shall be black, and on colored inserts the letters shall be of a contrasting color that will assure legibility.

3.3 Identification marking. Each box or envelopes of index tabs or strips shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished tabs shall be clean and uniform, and the edges shall be clean-cut. The occurrance of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality level.

3.5 Shelf life. The tabs shall under normal storage conditions retain their serviceability as defined by this specification for not less than 18 months from the time of shipment. Suppliers shall make replacements, without charge to the Government, of all tabs failing to meet these requirements.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection and testing of base material. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that base material is manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, standards and other documents. Each lot of paper or plastic used in the fabrication of tabs, and insert labels shall be tested in accordance with the applicable test methods specified hereinafter to determine compliance with the requirement of section 3.

4.1.2 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of using his own facilities, the contractor may submit a report of analysis of base material from a laboratory acceptable to the Government, whether an independent test facility or laboratory of raw material supplier, as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The report of analysis shall include, in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, the name and address of the testing laboratory, date of test(s), and quantity of material represented by the test report. When certification of compliance or report of analysis are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test to determine the validity of the certification or analysis.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All index tabs and strips of the same type, class, size and color presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purpose of examination and test.

4.2.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

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4.2.3 Sampling for visual inspection. Random sample boxes or envelopes of tabs shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one box or envelope of tabs, except that ten type I tabs, or two type II tab strips, and two strips of insert labels, taken at random, shall be examined for defects listed in table IX. The Inspection Level shall be S-3, and the Acceptable Quality Level (QPL) 2.5 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for performance tests. For each test, random sample boxes or envelopes of tabs shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one box or envelope of tabs, except that ten type I tabs, or two type II tab strips, and two strips of insert labels, taken at random, shall be tested as specified in 4.4.2.

4.2.5 Sampling for base material. A lot shall consist of one shipment of paper or plastic used in the manufacturer of tabs or insert labels, and received at one time from one source of supply, and shall be expressed in pounds of paper or square yards of plastic. The sample unit shall be 1 square foot of paper or plastic. The sample unit shall be selected from each lot of paper or plastic in accordance with table VIII.

TABLE VIII. Sample size

Pounds of paper or square yards of plastic	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	4

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table IX. Any tab or insert label in the sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE IX. Visual examination

Examine	Defects
Material	Material not as specified (see 3.1).
Type and class	Tabs not type or class as specified (see 1.2.1).
Adhesive	Less than 40 percent of the lower portion of the skirt is coated with an adhesive (see 3.2.1 and 3.2.2.1).
Release liner or backing	Adhesive not protected by a release liner or backing (see 3.2.1 and 3.2.2.1).
Dimensions	Dimensions of tabs and insert labels not as specified (see 3.2.1.1, and 3.2.2.2).
Color, type II	Color of tabs or insert labels not in accordance with the requirements stated in 3.2.2.5.
Legend	Legend not as specified (see 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.2.2).
Identification marking	Boxes or envelopes not marked as specified (see 3.3).
Workmanship	Workmanship not in accordance with 3.4.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Test for material. Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass the tests shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot, as not meeting the material requirements of this specification.

4.4.1.1 Plastic. The physical properties of the plastic shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods described in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406 to assure compliance with the requirements listed in 3.1.1. Unless otherwise specified, the samples for tests shall be conditioned at a temperature of 73.5° ± 2°F. (23.1° ± 1.1°C.) and a relative humidity of 50 ± 4 percent in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406.

TABLE X. Physical properties testing (plastic)

Physical properties	Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406	Number of determinations per sample unit
Tensile strength, pounds per square inch, minimum	Method A of Test Method 1013	2
Elongation at rupture, percent, minimum	Method A of Test Method 1013	2

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4.4.1.2 Paper. The physical properties of the paper for insert labels (type II) shall be tested in accordance with the applicable TAPPI test method listed in table XI, to assure compliance with the requirements listed in table II. All samples shall be conditioned and tested under uniform atmospheric conditions as specified in TAPPI test method T 402 os-49.

TABLE XI. Physical properties testing (paper)

Physical properties	TAPPI test methods	Number of determination per sample unit
Conditioning of paper and paperboard testing.	T 402 os - 49	
Basis weight.	T 410 os - 61	2
Thickness, inch	T 411 os - 44	2

4.4.1.3 Flammability. Cut a piece of plastic approximately 8 inches long and 1 inch wide from the base material. (See 4.2.5.) In a draft free area, hold the plastic specimen horizontally above a flame just touching the end of the specimen until it ignites, or for a period not over 30 seconds. If the specimen will not support combustion it is nonflammable. If the specimen burns, measure the burning rate in inches per minute and check for compliance with 3.1.1.

4.4.2 Test for end-item. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following test. Any tab in the sample failing the test shall be considered defective. If the number of defective tabs exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.2.1 Adhesion of pressure sensitive adhesive. The tabs shall be attached to bond paper conforming to type III of UU-P-121. After 2 hours of drying, it shall not be possible to remove the tabs without removing the surface of the paper.

4.4.2.2 Test for transparency. The tab skirt shall be directly applied over black 10 point (1/8 inch) print on white paper conforming to the paper specified in 4.4.2.1 and examined to assure compliance with the requirements stated in 3.1.1.1.

4.4.2.3 Test for ink receptivity (type II only). From each sample unit two insert labels shall be randomly selected and ten characters shall be typed on one insert label, and on the other label ten characters shall be written. A new ribbon shall be used for the typing test, and a steel pen for the writing test. The test shall assure compliance with the requirements specified in 3.1.4.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I. The type I, class 1 or 2 tabs shall be packaged in suitable boxes, or sealed, flexible plastic or kraft envelopes. The quantity shall be one set per box or envelope and 12 unit packages shall be further packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.2 Type II. The type II strips shall be packaged in suitable envelopes not exceeding 2-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches, sealed at both or one end. Envelopes sealed at one end shall have a flap on the open end of sufficient length to retain the contents until used. Quantity shall be one set per envelope and five envelopes shall be further packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. The tabs shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The tabs shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturers standard practice, providing that this insures protection for the tabs during shipment and provides for safe delivery to their destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. The tabs packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities specified in the contract or order in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, class weather resistant or PPP-B-640, class 2. Gross weight of the wood and wood-cleated boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. The fiber boxes shall not

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exceed the weight limitations of the applicable specification. Closure, sealing where applicable and strapping shall be in accordance with the applicable box specification or appendix thereto. The boxes shall be provided with case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2 Level B. The tabs packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in quantities specified in the contract or order in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class-domestic. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The tabs packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification rules and the National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tabs are intended to facilitate the identification of file and directory reference content.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, or type and class required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Dimensions of tabs required (see 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.2.2).
(d) Type of legend required (see 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.2.2).
(e) Whether tabs are required for vertical or horizontal attachment (for type I only; see table III).
(f) When other than clear colorless type II tabs are required, specify the color desired (see 3.2.2.5).
(g) Whether special tabs are required (see 1.2.1 and 6.3).
(h) Level or packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(i) Whether special marking is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Special tabs. Tabs having no legends, or different dimensions, legends, colors, or number of tabs per set as specified in this document, may be purchased under this specification. Purchasers should specify in complete details the characteristics of the tabs required. Purchasers are urged, however, to ascertain that the special tabs are required and that the tabs covered by this specification will not perform the desired function at less cost.

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: General Services Administration, FSS (FMSO), Wash., DC 20406.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

UU-T-001665(GSA-FSS) Tab, Index, Pressure Sensitive, Transparent

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

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